



Witness

*The record that holds up – identity,
language, and craft for an evidence layer.*

How to use this book

Witness exists to make work provable. This book keeps the brand as disciplined as the product: a quiet, warm, evidentiary voice, one accent of heat, and painted imagery used sparingly — never decoration for its own sake.

03	What Witness is	POSITIONING
04	Bearing witness	BRAND IDEA
05	Voice principles	VOICE
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What Witness is

Witness is the evidence layer for work that has to be provable. It watches the work as it happens, captures what actually occurred, and keeps an unbroken record anyone can stand behind.

THE JOB Turn scattered activity — captures, runs, sign-offs, field reports — into one account of record that survives scrutiny.	WHAT IT REPLACES Screenshot folders, spreadsheet trackers, and the sentence "trust me, it happened."
WHO IT'S FOR The operator who does the work, the engineer who instruments it, and the risk or compliance reader who has to accept it.	THE PROMISE Nothing gets lost, nothing gets embellished. If Witness says it happened, it happened.

ONE LINE, IN THE WILD

"Witness keeps the receipts, so your team can keep moving"

Bearing witness is an act of care

To witness something is to pay it attention — to stay present, notice honestly, and be able to say afterward what happened. That is a human posture before it is a technical one. Witness the product should feel the same way: attentive, unhurried, on your side. Rigor without coldness.

01

Present, not surveilling

We are on the side of the person doing the work. The record protects them first.

02

Plain over impressive

Evidence loses force when it is dressed up. We state, we don't sell.

03

Nothing unaccounted for

Gaps get named, not hidden. An honest "unknown" builds more trust than a confident guess.

04

Built to be read later

Every artifact assumes a future stranger. Clarity now is kindness then.

Warm, exact, unbothered

Witness sounds like a steady colleague who has read the whole file.
Short sentences. Concrete nouns. No hedging, no hype, no jargon
smuggled in as authority.

Plain-spoken	Use the word the user would use. "Signed off," not "attested." If a term is unavoidable, define it once, in-line.
Specific	Name the thing, the time, the actor. "Verified 14 of 16 steps at 4:02 PM" beats "verification complete."
Calm under fault	Errors are information, not alarm. Say what broke, what it means, and the one next move.
Credit the human	The person did the work; Witness only recorded it. Write in that order.
Never overclaim	No "guaranteed," "bulletproof," "100%." Our credibility is the product; don't spend it on adjectives.

TONAL RANGE

Onboarding: warmest. Records and audit views: flattest. Incidents: shortest.

NEVER

Exclamation marks, emoji, "Oops!", courtroom metaphors, watchdog language.

Say this, not that

SIGN-IN	Welcome back. Your record is where you left it.	Secure Access Portal — Authenticate to Continue
EMPTY STATE	No records yet. The first one starts the moment you begin work.	Nothing here! 🎉 Let's get you started on your journey.
GAP FOUND	Two steps have no evidence attached. Add it now, or mark why it's missing.	Warning: Compliance violation detected in your workflow!
SUCCESS	Recorded. Sent to Dana for sign-off.	Success! Your data has been securely and permanently immutably stored.
BUTTONS	Start recording / Attach evidence / Send for sign-off	Get Started / Submit / Learn More

BOILERPLATE — 40 WORDS

Witness is the evidence layer for work that has to be provable. It records what happened as it happens, verifies it, and keeps one account of record your team, your auditors, and your customers can all read.

The mark & its lockups

The mark stays as it is: a broken ring with three circles pushed through it — three points of view meeting around one shared center. That reading is the whole brand, so protect it. What changes is the setting: room around it, one of three sizes, and Newsreader as the wordmark beside it.

PRIMARY LOCKUP — INK ON BONE



REVERSED

Witness



MARK ONLY — APP
ICON, FAVICON,
AVATAR



Witness

STACKED — COVERS,
SIGN-IN



Witness

HORIZONTAL —
PRODUCT CHROME



WITH EMBER DOT —
LIVE RECORD ONLY

CLEAR SPACE

Clear space equals the diameter of one punched circle on all four sides. Nothing enters it — not a nav item, not a crop edge.

SIZES

Three only: 20px mark in app chrome, 30px stacked on nav, 58px+ on covers. Below 16px the mark goes alone — the wordmark drops.

PLACEMENT

Top-left in product, bottom-left on covers. The ring's opening always sits lower-right — never rotate the mark to fix a composition.

MISUSE

× Stretch

No condensing, skewing, or re-tracking.

× On paint

Never over active brushwork. Use a flat plate.

× Recolor

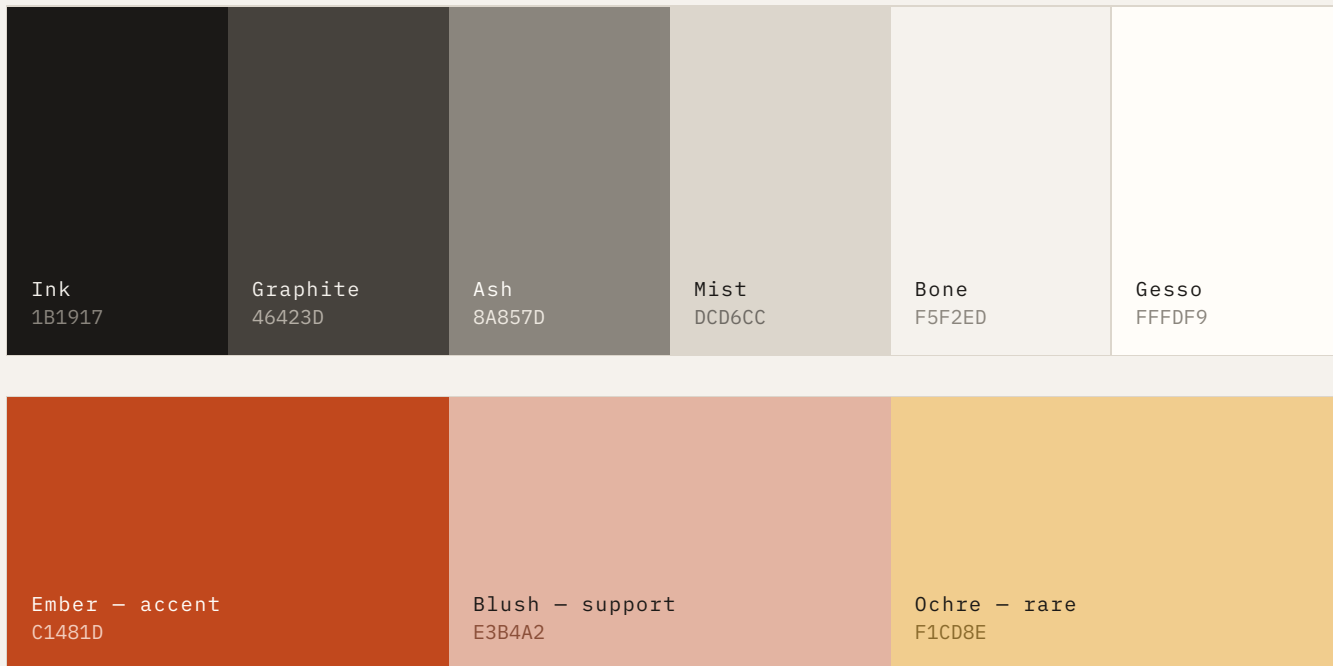
Ink or bone only. Never ember, never a filled ring.

× Effects

No shadow, glow, outline, or lock-up box.

Ash, bone, and one ember

The palette is pulled straight off the canvases: a grayscale built from ash and gessoed bone, warmed a half-step so it never reads clinical, with a single fire orange reserved for what matters right now.



RATIO

Roughly 90% neutral, 8% ink-on-dark inversion, 2% ember. If a page has more than one ember element competing, one of them is wrong.

SEMANTICS

Ember means live, unresolved, or needing you. Blush marks warm-but-passive states. Ochre appears only in painted imagery and data series.

Where the heat is allowed

STATUS LEDGER

- Recording now live
- Waiting on sign-off pending
- Verified & sealed closed
- No evidence attached gap

CONTROLS

Start recording

Attach evidence

Resolve 2 gaps

Primary action is ink, not ember. Ember is for the thing that needs attention, so it must not be the default button color.

DO

Let bone dominate. Long documents and audit views stay fully neutral.

DO

Use ink-field inversion for moments of emphasis — a cover, a quote, one section.

DON'T

No red/green success-failure pairs, no gradients, no pure #000 or #FFF anywhere.



SOURCE CANVAS — EMBER & OCHRE

Three voices, clearly divided

DISPLAY

Newsreader

Light 300 & Regular
400, italic for pull-
quotes. Tracking -2.5%.

The record that holds
up

Attentive, unhurried, on your side

INTERFACE & BODY

IBM Plex Sans

300–600. Body 16/1.6.
Never below 13px in
product.

Sixteen of sixteen steps verified

Plex Sans carries every functional surface — tables, forms,
navigation, body copy. It is neutral enough to disappear
and warm enough to feel written by someone.

EVIDENCE

IBM Plex Mono

Metadata, IDs,
timestamps, labels.
Uppercase +16%
tracking for labels.

2026-09-05 16:02:41Z

rec_9f3c004a1e · sha256:7b91d0

signed by dana.okafor@

RULE

Mono is not decoration — it signals machine-generated fact. If a human wrote it, it is not mono. That single discipline is what makes the interface feel evidentiary.

The scale

Hero

Newsreader 300
64 / 62 · -3.5%

Section head

Newsreader 300
44 / 46 · -2.5%

Pull-quote, italic

Newsreader 300 italic
26 / 34 · -1%

Subhead / card title

Plex Sans 500
22 / 28 · 0

Body copy. Sixteen over twenty-six, measure capped at 68 characters so a record stays readable at a glance.

Plex Sans 400
16 / 26 · 0

Secondary / helper text in dense tables and forms.

Plex Sans 400
14 / 21 · 0

EYEBROW / FIELD LABEL

Plex Mono 400
11 / 16 · +16% caps

SETTING

Headings balance, body wraps pretty. Left-aligned everywhere — never centered body copy, never justified.

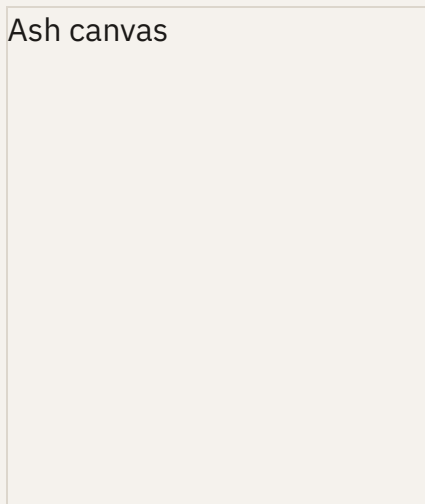
SPACING

An 8px base grid; hairline 1px rules in Mist do the dividing work that boxes and shadows would otherwise do.

Painted evidence

Three canvases carry the brand's emotional register: figures standing together, made of marks. They stand for the human side of the record — many small observations that add up to something you can recognise. Use them at cover scale or not at all.

Ash canvas



ASH — PRIMARY

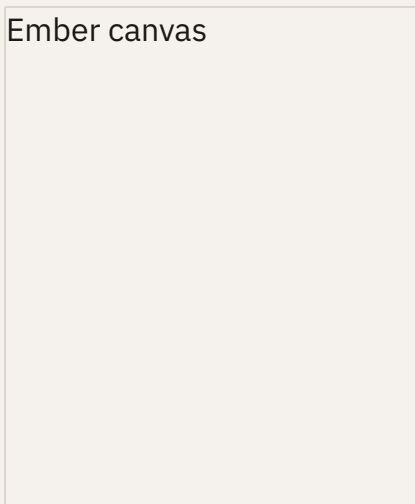
Default for covers, sign-in, and any hero. Cool, quiet, high bone content.



BLUSH — SECONDARY

People-facing moments: onboarding, customer stories, hiring.

Ember canvas



EMBER — PUNCTUATION

Rare. One high-energy moment per campaign — launches, keynotes.

CROP & SCALE

Crop into the paint until the figures read as texture, not illustration. Full-bleed or nothing — no floating rounded thumbnails, no drop shadows, no paint inside a card.

TYPE OVER PAINT

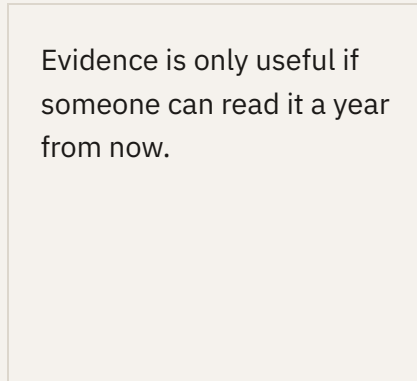
Only over the quietest third of the canvas, or over a flat ink scrim at 40–70%. Never tint the artwork itself and never overlay a color wash.

Three treatments, in order of use



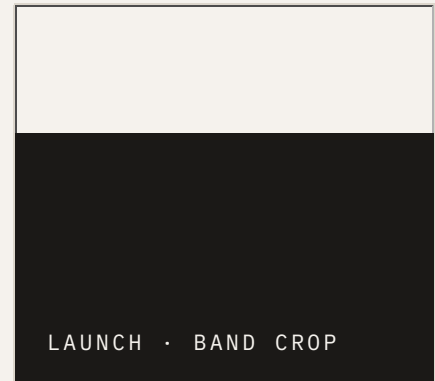
01 SCRIMMED HERO

Bottom-weighted ink gradient. The default.



02 GHOSTED FIELD

15–25% opacity behind text-led sections.



03 BAND

A thin slice of paint as a rule between sections.

ALSO ALLOWED

- Documentary photography of real work, desaturated a half-step.
- Screenshots of the actual product, cropped tight, never in a tilted device.
- Hairline diagrams in Ink and Mist — one weight, no fills.

NEVER

- Stock photos of handshakes, gavels, magnifying glasses, or eyes.
- Padlocks, shields, checkmark badges, blockchain cubes.
- Generated abstract renders, glowing nodes, particle networks.
- The paintings as pattern, tile, texture overlay, or logo fill.

Sign-in and the record

Everything you did
is still here.

Welcome back

Your record is where
you left it.

WORK EMAIL

dana.okafor@

PASSWORD

.....

Sign in

Use single sign-on
instead

☐ Witness

RECORDS

Line4 · shift 2

RECORDING

16:02	Pre-start checks signed	●
16:14	Torque log captured	●
16:31	Visual inspection	●
16:48	Supervisor sign-off	●

Two steps have no evidence
attached.

RESOLVE

APP.BUILDWITHWITNESS.COM/SIGNIN

RECORD VIEW — DENSITY, MONO METADATA, ONE
EMBER

CHROME

Hairline rules, no card
shadows, 4px radius
maximum. Gesso panels on
Bone ground.

MOTION

120–180ms, ease-out, opacity
and 4px translate only. The live
dot breathes at 2s. Nothing
bounces.

DENSITY

Records are lists first. Show
time, actor, and state on every
row before anything else.

Do & don't

DO

- Let white space carry the seriousness.
- Write the specific number, name, and time.
- Keep mono for machine facts only.
- Reserve ember for what is live or unresolved.
- Use paint full-bleed, at cover scale.
- Name gaps out loud.
- Show the real product, cropped tight.

DON'T

- Say bulletproof, guaranteed, or 100%.
- Use security clip-art — locks, shields, gavels.
- Put type over active brushwork.
- Add a second accent color "just for this".
- Use surveillance framing: watch, catch, police.
- Center body copy or justify text.
- Ship an interface louder than the evidence in it.

*If a choice makes the record easier to trust a year
from now, it is on brand.*

WITNESS BRAND BOOK
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